

8.1 Purpose of the Five-Role Structure

Cyberium field teams operate in unstable, high-risk environments involving rifts, systemic magical failures, and civilian exposure. To reduce collapse, injury, and cascading error, Cyberium employs a five-role team structure.

This structure ensures that every operation includes:

- leadership and decision-making
- system understanding
- direct intervention
- structural stability
- containment and recovery

Each role addresses a specific failure risk. No role replaces another.

8.2 Overview of Roles

A standard Cyberium field team consists of the following five roles:

1. Captain — Leadership and coordination
2. Reader — Analysis and interpretation
3. Lancer — Direct system interaction
4. Brawn — Stability and anchoring
5. Sealer — Containment and recovery

All Cyberium students receive foundational training in all five roles before specialization.

8.3 The Captain

Leadership and Operational Authority

The Captain directs the team during field operations.

Primary Responsibilities:

- make final operational decisions

- coordinate timing and task assignments
- communicate with the Court, DGA, and local authorities
- determine escalation, withdrawal, or mission termination

Captains do not override expertise. Their role is to decide when and how that expertise is used.

Common Risks:

- decision paralysis
- excessive control
- ethical oversimplification

8.4 The Reader

System Analysis and Interpretation

The Reader interprets unstable magical systems and communicates risk and pattern information to the team.

Primary Responsibilities:

- analyze rift and ley behavior
- identify failure conditions
- advise the Captain in real time
- document events for archival study

Readers translate complexity into usable understanding.

Common Risks:

- over-analysis
- delayed reporting
- cognitive overload

8.5 The Lancer

Direct System Interaction

The Lancer acts directly on unstable systems.

Primary Responsibilities:

- reroute magical flow
- apply temporary overrides
- perform rapid interventions
- adapt tactics during active failure

Lancers carry the highest operational risk.

Common Risks:

- system rejection
- desynchronization
- temporary or permanent lockout

8.6 The Brawn

Stability and Anchoring

The Brawn maintains structural integrity so the team can operate safely.

Primary Responsibilities:

- anchor ley lines
- reinforce boundaries
- absorb systemic load
- prevent collapse

Brawns do not solve problems — they keep problems solvable.

Common Risks:

- cognitive exhaustion
- emotional numbing
- identity drift

8.7 The Sealer

Containment, Closure, and Recovery

The Sealer is responsible for ending instability and reducing harm.

Primary Responsibilities:

- seal rifts and breaches
- contain residual effects
- stabilize affected individuals
- oversee safe disengagement

Sealers prioritize harm reduction over speed.

Common Risks:

- emotional bleed
- burnout
- over-identification with systems